

JIE DUAN

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EMPLOYMENT

Assistant Professor of Economics, Zhejiang University

July 2025-

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, National University of Singapore

August 2020 - June 2025

MSc. Economics, London School of Economics and Political Science

August 2018 - May 2019

B.A. Economics, Central University of Finance and Economics

September 2014 - June 2018

PUBLICATIONS

The Underemployment Trap (with Paul Jackson), *Journal of Monetary Economics*, 2025, Volume 155

Internet Linkage and International Trade: From the Perspective of Risk Alleviation (with Zengxi Hu), *The World Economy*, 2024, 47, 3551–3577.

WORKING PAPERS

Uncertainty, Learning, and the Unemployment-Education Gap over the Life Cycle, with Paul Jackson, Revise and Resubmit, *The Economic Journal*

Abstract: We propose that college graduates enter the labor market with less uncertainty regarding which career they are most productive in, and study how this characteristic contributes to the unemployment-education gap. We document several novel facts to support our hypothesis. Notably, college graduates predict their occupation more accurately than those without a college degree. We then develop and calibrate a life cycle search model featuring differences in uncertainty by education and learning about one's best career fit. Our quantitative analysis suggests large disparities in uncertainty by education, and that such differences can explain a sizeable portion of the unemployment-education gap.

Procyclical Wage Losses from Skill Mismatch

Abstract: This paper investigates the cyclicalities of wage losses from skill mismatch and the underlying mechanisms. Using the NLSY97, I find that wage losses due to skill mismatch are procyclical, with a one percentage point increase in the unemployment rate leading to a 1.3% reduction in wage losses, equivalent to a 14.6% recovery. I document that this effect is more pronounced in industries and occupations with higher training incidence, and that training provision is procyclical. To explain these findings, I develop a directed search model with skill mismatch and endogenous training that encompasses a productivity and training channel. The model demonstrates that declines in labor productivity and reduced training during recessions interact to reduce wage losses from skill mismatch.

(SELECTED) WORK IN PROGRESS

Lifelong Gains from a Strong Start: Early Career Fit, Learning, and the College Wage Premium, with Ismail Baydur (SMU) and Paul Jackson (NUS)

Job Search in China's Labor Market, with Yizhen Gu (PHBS, PKU), Paul Jackson (NUS) and Shengxing Zhang (CMU)

TEACHING

Lecturer, School of Economics, Zhejiang University

AI Economics (Graduate Course), Overall Evaluation: 4.81/5.00

Fall 2025

Economic Forecasting Methods (Graduate Course), Overall Evaluation: 4.88/5.00

Fall 2025

Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, National University of Singapore

EC6102 Advanced Macroeconomics Theory (Ph.D. Course)	Spring 2023, Spring 2022
EC5102 Macroeconomics Theory (Graduate Course)	Fall 2022

Exam Grader, Department of Economics, National University of Singapore

EC2102 Macroeconomic Analysis I (Undergraduate Course)	Fall 2024
EC2303 Foundations for Econometrics (Undergraduate Course)	Fall 2021
EC2101 Microeconomic Analysis I (Undergraduate Course)	Fall 2021

TALKS AND CONFERENCES

2022: Asian Econometric Society Meeting 2022 (Virtual)

2023: Asian Econometric Society Meeting 2023, Beijing; Asian Econometric Society Meeting 2023, Singapore; Econometric Society Australasian Meeting, Sydney; NUS Macro Brownbag; OzMac, Melbourne

2024: SWUFE; 7th ICCDS (SJTU); Asian Econometric Society Meeting 2024 (ZJU); China Labor Economists Forum (SUFE); 2024 Search and Matching Workshop in the Asia-Pacific (NUS); Duke-Kunshan; SUFE, School of Economics; Tongji University; SUFE, School of Business; Xiamen University; Zhejiang University; UIBE; Beijing Normal University

2025: ESWC 2025 (Seoul), Renmin University (Scheduled)

SERVICE

<i>Coordinator</i> , NUS Macro Workshop	2024
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AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Department Scholarship, NUS	2025
Research Incentive Award, NUS Econ Department	2023
Conference Funding For Graduate Students (SGD2,000), NUS	2023
Research Scholarship, NUS	2020 - 2024
Chinese Government Scholarship (GBP13,200), CSC	2018 - 2019
Honor Graduate, CUFE	2018
Overseas Education Scholarship (RMB50,000), CUFE	2018
Academic Excellence Award (Top 4%), CUFE	2015, 2016, 2017

MISCELLANEOUS

Programming: Stata, Matlab, Mathematica, $\text{\LaTeX}$
Language: Mandarin (native), English (proficient)
Personal: Born in 1996 Oct., female

Last updated: December 2025